

iPhone 4S. Shortly afterward, it was removed as a standalone app from the App store.

From promise to purpose: The problems with becoming a Big Shot

Apple faced many teething problems while integrating Siri into the iPhone. Originally, Siri was basically the centerpoint of a database of over 40 services and was programmed to understand the user query and find the best combination of results. Even as Apple was modifying Siri to broaden its horizons, it was diminishing its returns. Take for example, the restaurant booking feature that was available on the original Siri way back in 2010. While it doesn't seem like that big a deal right now, it was one of Siri's biggest unique selling points. It wasn't offered to Apple users till late 2012, almost two years after it was officially released.

It was theorised that this is because of Apple's acquisition of Siri. When it was a burgeoning voice assistant application, there was little-to-no red tape involved when making associations with industry leaders in fields such as Search Engines, Restaurant and Hotel Booking, Location Detecting et al. However, with Apple now owning Siri, making such associations involved a lot of negotiating and even more paperwork.

Adding to this was the relative infancy of the entire field of Natural Language Processing, which meant further delays in rolling out the best version of Siri. As a corporate entity, Apple had responsibilities towards its customers to ensure that Siri functioned well in the nearly 100 countries that Apple was selling its products in. The iPhone was expected to recognise



Natural Language Processing has been one of the key areas of critique. There have been instances of Siri not recognising Asian accents, much to Apple's embarrassment.